



Full by Day Nine, Collected on Day Fourteen

A Three-Year Bin-Sensor Pilot the Collection Calendar Has Never Once Consulted

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Background

Facilities collects confidential-waste bins on a fixed fortnightly run regardless of use. A fill-level sensor was piloted on fourteen bins beside high-traffic photocopiers three years ago to test demand-responsive scheduling. Has the run ever adapted to what the pilot reports?

Aims

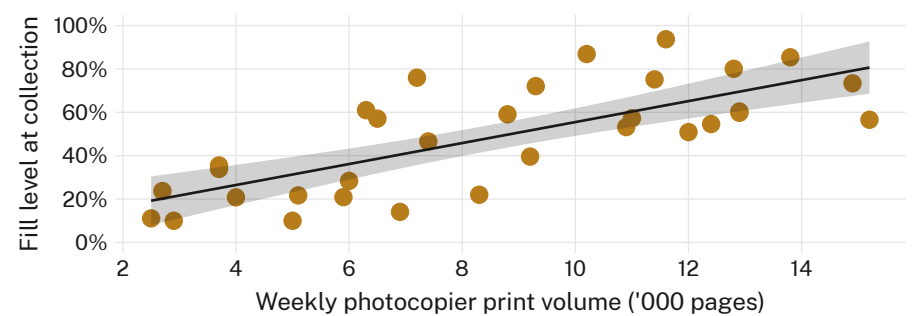
- Test whether fill level at collection tracks the preceding week's photocopier print volume.
- Establish whether the fortnightly collection interval has shifted at any point since the pilot began.
- Trace how the pilot's status is renewed each budget cycle without being formalised or discontinued.

Methods

- 14 bins · pilot ultrasonic fill sensor · fortnightly readings · 3-year deployment.
- Weekly photocopier print-volume logs matched to the nearest fill reading, 32 sampled collection cycles.
- Six annual capital-works submissions coded for the sensor pilot's line-item status.

Results

Fill level at collection tracks the preceding week's print volume ($r = 0.74$, $n = 32$ cycles). In assessment-period cycles, sampled bins reached $\geq 90\%$ capacity by day nine of the fourteen-day interval.



Fill level at collection rose with the preceding week's print volume across all 32 sampled cycles ($r = 0.74$); the 14-day collection interval did not shorten once, including during assessment weeks.

Discussion & conclusions

The sensor performs; the interval doesn't listen. Six consecutive capital-works submissions describe the same fourteen bins as a live pilot, never adopted, never wound up, each one re-costing the same hardware as a one-off trial expense rather than routine plant. Whoever collated the readings appears never to have been asked to act on them. The correlation is not the finding here; the calendar's indifference to it is. Next: a decommissioning or promotion decision, on any timeline.

References

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Bin contents were not inspected; only fill-level telemetry and print-log volumes were retained. Capital-works submissions accessed under standard records request.

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